Chapter 10: Architecture Roles, Skills, and Competencies

Study Guide, based on Mastering the TOGAF Standard by Eric Jager (2025), Chapter 10 (pp. 247-278)

Overview

Chapter 10 (pp. 247-278) covers the people side of the Architecture Capability: which roles exist, how to tell jobs from roles, and what skills and competencies architects need. Section 10.1 distinguishes **job**, **role**, and **assignment** (pp. 248-249). Section 10.2 describes the core roles from the "Architecture Roles and Skills" Series Guide: Chief Architect (a specialization of Enterprise Architect), Enterprise, Segment, and Solution Architect (pp. 249-255). Section 10.3 examines the Segment Architect from a **horizontal** (architecture-domain) and a **vertical** (business-segment) perspective (pp. 255-263). Section 10.4 covers TOGAF's skill categories and proficiency levels, then adds Jager's own list of **ten competencies**, which the Standard lacks (pp. 263-277). Section 10.5 summarizes (pp. 277-278). Leave with this idea: each of the four Architecture Capabilities from Chapter 9 maps to a role, and architects need competencies (skills plus abilities plus knowledge), not just skills (pp. 259, 266). Chapter 10 is part of the GREEN and GOLD reading tours (p. 247).

> **Reading note:** Roles, skill categories, and proficiency levels come from the Standard and its Series Guides (G198, G249). The ten competencies and Table 10-3 are Jager's own addition, because "a list of competencies... is exactly what is missing from the TOGAF Standard" (p. 266). His anecdotes (the "Tribe Architect", p. 258; leaving an IT-minded employer, p. 267) and the Governance Framework inconsistency (Domain vs. Segment Architect, p. 262) are his commentary.

Detailed Section Breakdown

Chapter Opener (pp. 247-248)

- Establishing the Architecture Capability and forming the architecture team happen early in the Preliminary Phase and depend on defining the right roles, skills, and competencies. A skills framework helps (p. 247).
- The 2024 Series Guide "Architecture Roles and Skills" gives a fuller picture of skills per role, but ambiguity about jobs and roles persists in practice (pp. 247-248).

10.1 Difference Between Jobs, Roles, and Assignments (pp. 248-249)

Term	Definition (Architecture Roles and Skills)
Job	The formal position, usually defined by an employment contract and tied to hierarchy
Role	The expected set of activities, typically tied to a skill set
Assignment	A specific task or project a person is responsible for, usually within their job and role

(p. 248)

- **Why it matters.** Unclear whether "Enterprise Architect" is a job or a role, organizations struggle to position architecture, and it stays seen as part of IT, which needs different skills from strategic work (pp. 248-249).

- **Segment Architect is a job.** TOGAF created the Segment Architect profile to end confusion over domain roles (Technical, Application, Business Architect). It is a complete package with a role description and responsibilities (p. 249).

10.2 Core Architecture Roles (pp. 249-255)

- **Starting point to tailor.** People may hold several roles and roles may be shared. The guide gives three primary viewpoints (enterprise, segment, solution), which equal the three core roles. Specialist, user, and stakeholder roles are left to other professional frameworks (pp. 249-250, Figure 10-1).
- **Tiered model.** The Chief Architect at the top, then Enterprise, then Segment, with increasing depth for distinct parts of the landscape. A minimal three-tier model that can be expanded (organizations typically have 3-7 management levels) (pp. 250-251).

Role	Essence	Key responsibilities	Page
Chief Architect	Special case of the Enterprise Architect. Integrates the EA view into the wider strategic and operational context	Unifies executives and board around the landscape vision; makes concepts accessible; leads roadmaps for transformation; accountable for landscape governance; leads EA, Segment, and Solution Architects	pp. 251-252
Enterprise Architect	Seasoned expert steering transformative change that bridges business and technology across the organization	Leads major initiatives with a seat at the senior table; builds roadmaps across business segments; defines guiding principles and policies; establishes the framework for integration, interoperability, governance; coaches and mentors	pp. 252-253
Segment Architect	Manages and champions specific business or technical capabilities within a segment	Defines, shapes, and governs systems and components; creates segment blueprints; covers policies and standards; ensures compliance; fosters integration within the segment	pp. 253-254
Solution Architect	Drives delivery of new or evolved capabilities	Crafts solutions meeting immediate requirements and goals within service levels; decomposes into systems and components; builds roadmaps via Transition Architectures; ensures adherence to principles and standards	pp. 254-255

- **Dashed line (Figure 10-2).** It shows that the Chief Architect is a specialization of the Enterprise Architect, not a separate role (p. 251).

Jager's commentary (author's view): In Europe few organizations recognize the Chief Architect, so its duties are usually merged into the Enterprise Architect role (p. 252).

10.3 The Role of the Segment Architect (pp. 255-263)

- **Same job, different roles.** A Segment Architect assigned to infrastructure takes a Technology role (likely in IT). One assigned to business issues takes a Business Architecture role. The job is the same, but roles, skills, and competencies differ. Hierarchy follows the *assignment*, not the job description (p. 255).
- **Definitions.** "A segment groups capabilities in a structured way, often as part of a larger portfolio or specific change program." A domain is "any useful grouping of capabilities", with four segment-based viewpoints: business, application, data, technology (p. 256).

Perspective	Basis	Segment Architect becomes...	Source	Page
Horizontal	The four architecture domains	Business, Data, Application, or Technology Architect	Fundamental Content	pp. 255-256

Perspective	Basis	Segment Architect becomes...	Source	Page
Vertical	Organizational pillars (business domains), each holding several architecture domains	Architect for one pillar, e.g., Research, Consultation, Treatment	Only in the Roles and Skills Series Guide	pp. 256-257, 260-261

Jager's commentary (author's view): The vertical perspective makes role assignment hard. Each pillar often combines Business, Data, and Application, while Technology sits with IT "in nine out of ten cases". This leads to "nonsensical" new roles, such as a "Tribe Architect" in an agile organization (pp. 257-258).

10.3.1 The Horizontal Perspective (pp. 258-260)

Architecture Capability (Ch. 9)	Core role	Example specializations
Support strategy	Chief Architect and/or Enterprise Architect	n/a
Support portfolio	Segment Architect	Business, Data, Application, Technology Architect
Support projects	Segment Architect	Business, Data, Application, Technology Architect
Support solution delivery	Solution Architect	Cloud, Network, Software Architect

(pp. 259-260, Figures 10-4, 10-5)

- If there is no Chief Architect, the Enterprise Architect takes the strategic side as well (p. 259).
- Combining roles into one creates ambiguity about which capability is delivered and who is responsible (p. 260).

10.3.2 The Vertical Perspective (pp. 260-263)

- **Pillars as segments.** In healthcare, the pillars might be Research, Consultation, and Treatment. Each holds a Segment Architecture spanning all four domains (pp. 260-261, Figure 10-6).
- **More operational.** Owning Application and Technology domains makes the vertical Segment Architect's work more substantive, overlapping with Solution Architect work (p. 261).
- **Segment vs. Solution Architecture (Figure 10-7).** A Solution Architecture is a discrete, focused business operation and how IT supports it, usually for a single project or release. A Segment Architecture covers a whole pillar, whose services are used across other processes (pp. 261-262).

Jager's commentary (author's view): The Governance Framework (Ch. 8) names Chief, Enterprise, and *Domain* Architects but not Segment or Solution Architects. This is an inconsistency that The Open Group told him it is gradually fixing (pp. 262-263).

10.4 Skills and Competencies (pp. 263-277)

- **Division of labour.** The Enterprise Architect does the strategic work, the Segment Architect details segments or domains, and the Solution Architect details proposed solutions (p. 264).
- **Skills frameworks.** Define roles in a work area, the skills each needs, and the depth required. The "Architecture Skills Framework" (G198) was updated in September 2024 as "Architecture Roles and Skills" (G249) (p. 264).

Skill category (Table 10-1)	Examples	Page
Application	Application management, API patterns, software design principles	p. 265

Skill category (Table 10-1)	Examples	Page
Architecture	Modelling, building block design, principle design, migration planning, Security Architecture, requirements management, governance	p. 265
Business	Enterprise organization knowledge, business cases, business process, strategic planning	p. 265
Change	Managing business change, project management methods and tools	p. 265
Data	Data analysis, exchange, management	p. 265
Generic	Leadership, teamworking, interpersonal skills	p. 265
Legal	Data protection, contract, procurement law, fraud	p. 265
Technology	Compute, storage, network infrastructure	p. 265

Proficiency level (Table 10-2)	Meaning
1 Background	Basic understanding, reliant on specialists
2 Aware	Understands and can address issues, with specialist support
3 Knowledgeable	Enough detail for effective decisions. Specialist input only in difficult cases
4 Expert	Extensive experience, practical and applied knowledge

(p. 266)

- **Competency vs. skill (Figure 10-8).** A competency combines skills, abilities, and knowledge. The Standard lists skills and proficiency levels but no competencies (p. 266).

Jager's ten competencies	Core idea	Mainly needed by (Table 10-3)	Page
Strategic thinking and vision	Turn long-term vision into strategy and roadmap initiatives. Anticipate. Think holistically	Enterprise (and Segment)	p. 268
Strategic decision-making	Decide under uncertainty. Present scenarios and trade-offs (Ch. 14.9)	Enterprise, Segment	p. 269
Leadership and influence	Inspire teams, build consensus, be a trusted advisor	Enterprise	p. 269
Change leadership	Drive change with resilience. Handle resistance. Be culturally sensitive	Enterprise, Segment	p. 269
Business and technology alignment	Bridge strategy and technology. State tech value in business terms	Enterprise, Segment	pp. 269-270
Communication and collaboration	Explain complex ideas to any audience. Listen	Segment, Solution (listening: all)	p. 270
Governance and compliance	Enforce standards. Ensure regulatory adherence. Measure effectiveness	All three	p. 270
Adaptability and resilience	Adapt to change, keep composure, keep learning	All three	p. 270
Analytical thinking and problem solving	Break problems down, find root causes, apply structured creativity	All three	p. 271
Systems thinking	Understand interconnectedness. Design scalable, sustainable solutions	Segment, Solution	p. 271

- Each competency maps to skills in the Series Guide (Figure 10-9, p. 276). The SFIA 9 skills directory is suggested for further reading (p. 277).

Jager's commentary (author's view): An employer that saw architecture as IT reduced his strategic role to IT scope, and he ended the contract. Agree upfront on the perspective from which the architecture work

will be done, so that skills and competencies match (pp. 267-268).

10.5 Summary (pp. 277-278)

- Three viewpoints equal three core roles: Enterprise (with the Chief specialization), Segment (formerly Domain), and Solution (pp. 277-278).
- The organization can be viewed horizontally (four domains) or vertically (service segments) (p. 278).
- The Standard covers only skills and proficiency. The book adds ten competencies mapped to those skills (p. 278).

Key Terms & Definitions

Term	Definition	Page
Job / Role / Assignment	Formal contractual position / expected activities tied to a skill set / specific task or project	p. 248
Chief Architect	Specialization of the Enterprise Architect that integrates the EA view into strategic and operational context	p. 251
Segment Architect	Job profile (formerly Domain Architect) for a segment of the architecture, horizontal or vertical	pp. 249, 263
Segment	A structured grouping of capabilities, often part of a portfolio or change program	p. 256
Horizontal perspective	Segments based on the four architecture domains	pp. 255-256
Vertical perspective	Segments based on organizational pillars or business domains	pp. 256, 260
Skills framework	Defines roles, skills per role, and depth of knowledge needed	p. 264
Proficiency levels	Background, Aware, Knowledgeable, Expert	p. 266
Competency	Skills plus abilities plus knowledge	p. 266

Figures & Tables Referenced

Figure / Table	What it shows	Page
Figures 10-1, 10-2	Core architecture roles and relationships	pp. 250-251
Figure 10-3	Business domains/segments vs. architecture domains	p. 257
Figures 10-4, 10-5	Architecture Capabilities mapped to roles and specializations	pp. 259-260
Figure 10-6	Vertical perspective and associated architectures	p. 261
Figure 10-7	Segment vs. Solution Architectures	p. 262
Table 10-1	Skill categories	p. 265
Table 10-2	Proficiency levels	p. 266
Figure 10-8	Competencies vs. skills	p. 267
Table 10-3	Required competencies per core role	pp. 272-275
Figure 10-9	Competencies mapped to skills	p. 276

Self-Check Questions

Q: Define job, role, and assignment.

A: Job: the formal contractual position. Role: the expected set of activities tied to a skill set. Assignment: a specific task or project, usually within the job and role (p. 248).

Q: What are the three core architecture roles, and how does the Chief Architect relate to them?

A: Enterprise, Segment, and Solution Architect. The Chief Architect is a specialization of the Enterprise Architect, not a separate role (pp. 251, 263).

Q: What did the Segment Architect replace, and is it a job or a role?

A: It replaced the Domain Architect. It is a job profile that includes a role description and responsibilities (pp. 249, 263).

Q: Match each of the four Architecture Capabilities to a core role.

A: Strategy: Chief/Enterprise Architect. Portfolio and projects: Segment Architect. Solution delivery: Solution Architect (p. 259).

Q: Contrast the horizontal and vertical perspectives on segments.

A: Horizontal segments follow the four architecture domains. Vertical segments follow organizational pillars, each containing several or all domains. The vertical view appears only in the Series Guide (pp. 255-257, 260).

Q: Why does the vertical perspective make the Segment Architect role more operational?

A: The architect becomes responsible for the Application and Technology domains in the pillar, which is usually Solution Architect territory (p. 261).

Q: Name the four proficiency levels.

A: 1 Background, 2 Aware, 3 Knowledgeable, 4 Expert (p. 266).

Q: How does a competency differ from a skill?

A: A competency consists of skills plus abilities plus knowledge (p. 266).

Q: Name at least six of Jager's ten competencies.

A: Strategic thinking and vision; strategic decision-making; leadership and influence; change leadership; business and technology alignment; communication and collaboration; governance and compliance; adaptability and resilience; analytical thinking and problem solving; systems thinking (pp. 268-271).

Q: What inconsistency does Jager note between the Governance Framework and the roles Series Guide?

A: The Governance Framework lists Chief, Enterprise, and Domain Architects, while the Series Guide uses Segment Architect and adds Solution Architect, which the framework does not mention (p. 262).

Q: Why should architect and organization agree on perspective before work starts?

A: A mismatch between the architect's (e.g., strategic) competencies and the organization's (e.g., IT-only) view of the discipline leaves both dissatisfied (pp. 267-268).